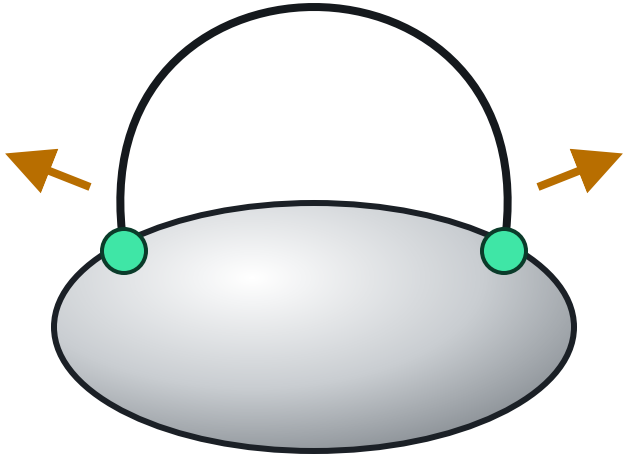
ssDNA spring

single strand only

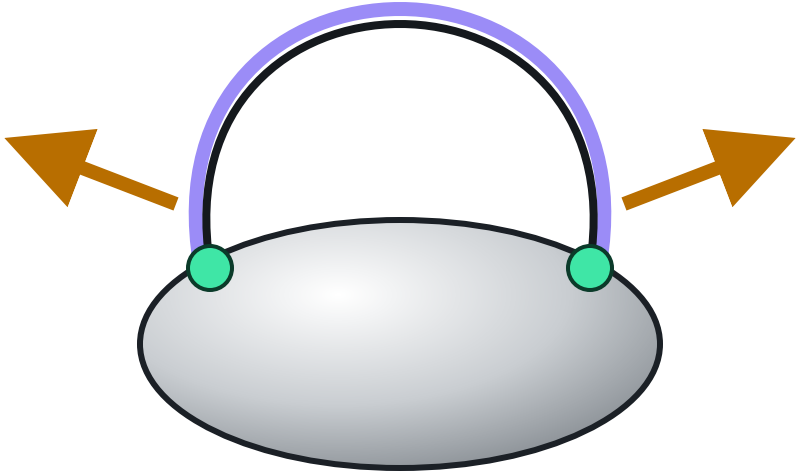


weak force

floppy strand: little push

dsDNA spring

ssDNA + complementary strand (cDNA)

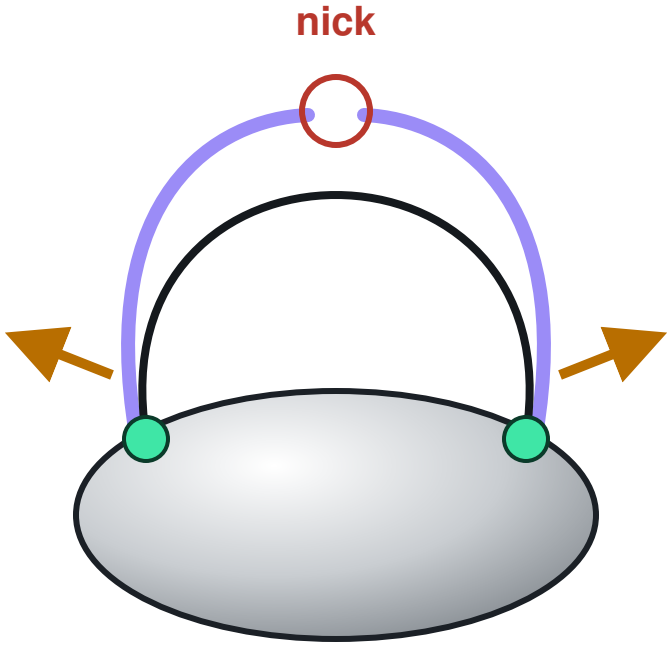


strong force

stiff duplex pushes the sites apart

nicked dsDNA

cDNA with one break in its backbone



reduced force

same DNA mass, weaker spring

Schematic (not to scale): green = Tet attachment sites on the protein, black = ssDNA, purple = complementary strand